

Auction Portal — Testing Guide

For the person reviewing this system

Version 0.1 (Phase 1) · September 2026

1. What this is

A website that collects bank auction listings from public sources and puts them in one searchable place. Banks sell seized property and vehicles when borrowers default; the notices are published, but scattered across dozens of websites in dozens of formats. This portal gathers them.

What it can do today

- Collects listings automatically from **BAANKNET**, the Government of India auction platform used by all 12 public sector banks
- Collects **repossessed vehicles** from the same platform
- Lets anyone search and filter by bank, state, city, property type, possession status and price
- Shows reserve price, EMD, auction dates and inspection windows
- Links every listing back to the bank's original notice
- Updates itself on a schedule with no one touching it

What it cannot do yet

This is Phase 1. The following are **deliberately** not built:

Not yet	Why	When
ICICI, HDFC, Axis and other private banks	Their notices are PDFs and need OCR	Phase 2
Auction platforms (C1 India, AuctionTiger)	Mixed HTML and PDF formats	Phase 3
Newspaper notices	Hardest source; needs vernacular OCR	Phase 5
Email or WhatsApp alerts	Needs user accounts first	Phase 4
Bidding or payments	Never. We are not an auctioneer.	—

Please do not report these as defects. They are scheduled work.

2. What you are testing against

At the time of writing the system holds:

Listings	85 (84 published, 1 withheld on purpose)
Properties	60
Vehicles	25
Banks	11 public sector banks
Cities	64
Price range	₹40,375 to ₹44.65 crore

This is a **sample**, not full coverage. BAANKNET publishes around 72,000 properties; we deliberately crawl slowly and politely, so building the full set takes time. The point of Phase 1 is to prove the machinery works.

3. Starting the system

You need two things running: the **database** and the **portal**.

Open PowerShell in the project folder (`D:\Anubhav Jain bankproject`) and run these in order.

Step 1 — start the database

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe scripts\setup_postgres.py --start
```

Expected:

```
binaries : present
data dir : initialised
server   : running (port 5433)
```

The database does **not** start automatically when Windows boots. If you restart the machine, run this again.

Step 2 — start the portal

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal serve
```

Expected:

```
portal running at http://127.0.0.1:8000
api docs at      http://127.0.0.1:8000/api/docs
press Ctrl+C to stop
```

Leave this window open. The portal runs until you press **Ctrl+C**.

Step 3 — open it

Go to **<http://127.0.0.1:8000>** in any browser.

4. Test checklist

Work through these in order. Each has a clear expected result.

A. The home page

#	Do this	Expect
A1	Open <code>http://127.0.0.1:8000</code>	A list of properties, newest auction first
A2	Look at the top bar	Counts for listings, states and banks
A3	Check a price	Shown as Rs 37.65 L or Rs 3.38 Cr , never 3765000
A4	Check an auction date	Indian format and IST, e.g. 29 Sep 2026, 11:00
A5	Scroll to the bottom	A disclaimer, and a statement that we are not a bank

B. Searching

#	Do this	Expect
B1	Type Kanpur in the search box, press Search	Only Kanpur listings
B2	Search Baroda	Listings from Bank of Baroda
B3	Search Antarctica	"Nothing matches those filters", not an error page
B4	Clear the search	All listings return

C. Filtering

#	Do this	Expect
C1	Click Gujarat in the State list	Only Gujarat listings; a "Gujarat ×" chip appears
C2	Look at the State list again	Other states still visible with their counts
C3	Add a property type filter	Both filters apply together
C4	Click the × on a chip	That filter is removed, the other stays
C5	Click Clear all	Back to everything
C6	Enter Min 1000000 , Max 5000000 , click Apply	Only listings in that price band

C2 is worth checking carefully. Selecting Gujarat must not reduce the state list to only Gujarat, or you could never switch state without clearing the filter first.

D. Sorting and paging

#	Do this	Expect
D1	Sort by Price (lowest first)	Cheapest at the top
D2	Sort by Price (highest first)	The ₹44.65 crore listing at the top
D3	Sort by Auction date (soonest)	Nearest auction first
D4	Click Next at the bottom	Page 2; "Page 2 of N" shown
D5	Filter by a state, then look at the page number	Resets to page 1, not a blank page 7

E. A single listing

#	Do this	Expect
E1	Click any listing	A detail page opens
E2	Look for the money	Reserve price, EMD, bid increment, auction opening time
E3	Find "View the original notice"	Opens the bank's own page on baanknet.com
E4	Look under that button	"first seen" and "last verified" times
E5	Open a listing tagged symbolic possession	An orange warning that occupants may still be living there
E6	Open one tagged DRT	A warning that it is not a standard SARFAESI auction
E7	Click a city in the breadcrumb	Filters to that city

F. Things that must NOT happen

These are the important ones.

#	Check	Expect
F1	Search any page for the word "borrower"	Never appears. We do not publish who defaulted.
F2	Search for "guarantor"	Never appears
F3	Visit http://127.0.0.1:8000/listing/999999	A clean "Listing not found" page, not a crash
F4	Look for a "Bid now" or "Pay EMD" button	Must not exist. We are not an auctioneer.
F5	Look for a map pin on every listing	Some have none — that is correct , see below

F5 explained. Some listings show no location. The source data contains wrong coordinates — one Azamgarh property was published in the Arabian Sea. Where we cannot verify a coordinate falls inside the state it claims, we show nothing. A wrong pin on a ₹38 lakh property is worse than no pin.

G. The JSON API

For anyone technical on your side.

#	Do this	Expect
G1	Open <code>http://127.0.0.1:8000/api/docs</code>	Interactive API documentation
G2	Open <code>http://127.0.0.1:8000/api/listings</code>	JSON with a <code>disclaimer</code> field
G3	Open <code>http://127.0.0.1:8000/api/health</code>	<code>{"status": "ok", ...}</code>
G4	Search the JSON for "borrower"	Not present

H. Checking it all at once

If you would rather not click through every item above, this runs the important checks against the live site and reports pass or fail.

With the portal running, in a **second** PowerShell window:

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe scripts\verify_manual.py
```

Expected: 18 lines all reading `[PASS]`, ending with

```
All manual claims verified against live data.
```

It exits non-zero if anything fails, so it also works as an automated check. This does **not** replace looking at the pages yourself — it cannot tell you whether the site is pleasant to use, only whether it is behaving correctly.

5. Checking the automatic side

The portal is only half the system. The other half collects the data. Open a **second** PowerShell window, leaving the portal running.

Is everything healthy?

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal health
```

Expected:

```
[ok ] baanknet          healthy      last run 27 Sep 00:49
[ok ] baanknet_vehicle  healthy      last run 27 Sep 00:45
```

FAIL means a source has stopped producing data — usually because the website changed and the collector needs updating.

Collect more listings

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal crawl baanknet --limit 20
```

This takes about a minute. It waits three seconds between requests on purpose — we do not hammer anyone's website. Refresh the portal afterwards and the new listings appear.

See what has been collected

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal stats
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal listings --state Gujarat
```

Check for duplicates and re-auctions

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal dedup
```

Reports two things: the same property listed twice, and the same property being re-auctioned later at a lower price. It **reports only** — nothing is merged automatically, because a wrong merge is hard to notice.

Run it fully automatically

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal schedule
```

This is how it runs in production: crawls every 6 hours, re-checks imminent auctions hourly, updates statuses every 15 minutes, and checks its own health every 2 hours. Press **Ctrl+C** to stop.

Add **--dry-run** to list the jobs without starting them.

6. Deliberate design decisions

Please read this before reporting these as bugs.

One listing is hidden. Of 85 collected, 84 are shown. The hidden one is a Mumbai property where the bank uploaded a reserve price of ₹1 — a placeholder. Rather than display a nonsense price, the system withholds it. You can see it with **listings --all**.

We show fewer listings rather than wrong ones. Every listing gets a confidence score. Below 0.70 it is stored but not published. This means slightly lower coverage and no wrong prices. That trade was chosen deliberately.

Some listings say "unscheduled". Banks list properties before fixing an auction date. That is normal, not missing data.

Borrower names are never shown. Not hidden — never stored. Publishing that someone defaulted causes real harm and adds nothing for a buyer.

Old auctions disappear after 90 days. Concluded auctions stop being publicly searchable. The data is kept internally; it just stops being indexed.

7. If something goes wrong

Problem	Fix
"cannot connect" / database errors	<code>python scripts\setup_postgres.py --start</code>
Portal will not start, "address in use"	Another copy is running. Close it, or use <code>serve --port 8001</code>
Page loads but shows no listings	Database is empty. Run <code>crawl baanknet --limit 20</code>
A crawl fails with network errors	Check your internet. It retries automatically.
Prices look wrong	Please report it — include the listing URL. This matters most.

To restart from scratch:

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe scripts\setup_postgres.py --reset
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe scripts\setup_postgres.py
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m alembic upgrade head
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal crawl baanknet --limit 50
```

8. Reporting what you find

For anything wrong, please include:

1. **What you did** — the page, the filters, the exact search
2. **What you expected**
3. **What happened** — a screenshot helps
4. **The listing URL** if it concerns specific data

Priority order for us:

Priority	Kind of problem
Critical	A wrong reserve price, EMD or auction date
Critical	Any borrower or personal detail appearing anywhere
High	A listing linking to the wrong original notice
High	Filters or search returning wrong results
Medium	Missing listings, layout problems
Low	Wording, styling, ordering preferences

The two critical rows are the ones that would genuinely damage a user. Everything else can wait.

9. Before this can go live publicly

This system is **not yet ready for public use**, for reasons that are nothing to do with the software:

1. **A lawyer must review it.** An Indian technology and IP lawyer needs to check the data collection approach, the disclaimers, the privacy policy and the position under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act.
2. **A real contact page.** Our collector currently identifies itself with a placeholder address. Before crawling at volume, that must point to a live page explaining what the bot does and how to ask it to stop.
3. **A published takedown process**, with a named contact and a committed response time.
4. **Proper hosting** — managed database, backups, HTTPS, a domain.

Estimated running cost once live: **₹1,000 – 6,500 per month**.

Full detail is in [docs/DEPLOYMENT.md](#).

10. Quick reference

```
# Start the database (needed after every reboot)
.\.env\Scripts\python.exe scripts\setup_postgres.py --start

# Start the portal          -> http://127.0.0.1:8000
.\.env\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal serve

# Collect more listings
.\.env\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal crawl baanknet --limit 20
.\.env\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal crawl baanknet_vehicle --limit 20

# Inspect
.\.env\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal stats
.\.env\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal health
.\.env\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal listings --state Gujarat
.\.env\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal dedup

# Run everything automatically
.\.env\Scripts\python.exe -m auction_portal schedule

# Verify the site behaves as this guide says (18 live checks)
.\.env\Scripts\python.exe scripts\verify_manual.py

# Confirm the code is sound (301 automated tests)
.\.env\Scripts\python.exe -m pytest
```